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CUSTODY / LEDGER CASE

CASE STUDY — OCT 2026

The wallet didn’t fail.

The chain did.

The device worked as designed.

Users still lost money.

01 — WHAT HAPPENED

Real devices. Hidden implant.

A Criminals bought genuine Ledger wallets.

B Hid a 3-chip implant inside.

C At setup, it read the 24 words and sent them out over LTE.

02 — LEDGER'S VERDICT · OCT 15

Secure chip	INTACT
Operating system	INTACT
Servers	INTACT
The handoffs	UNOWNED

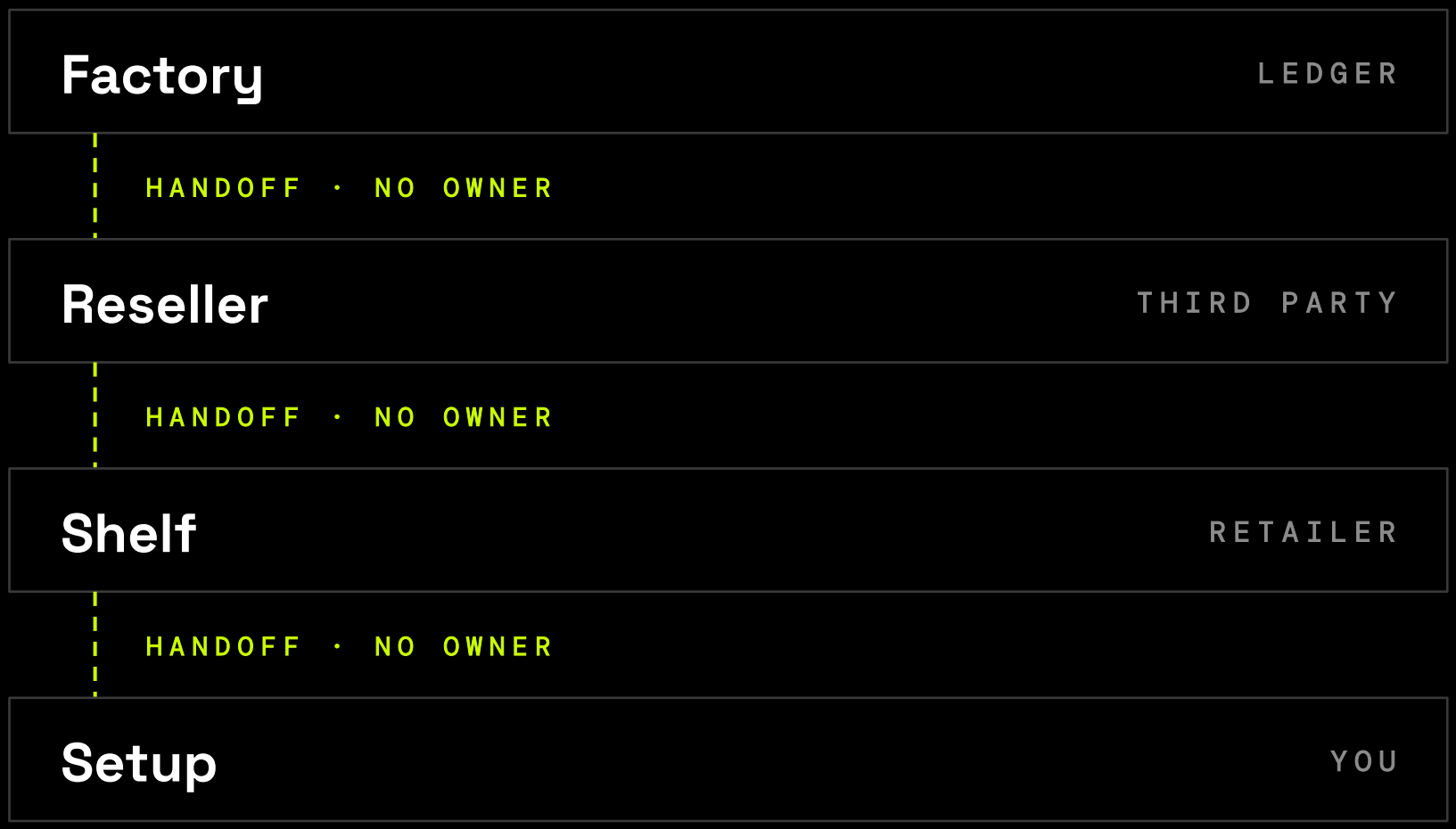
Every part held.
The money still left.

The attack didn't break the product.

It went around it.

03 — THE REAL PRODUCT

Money left at the handoffs nobody owned.



Each step trusted the one before it.

04 — GOLDRATT, THE GOAL

A system is only as strong as its constraint.

Improve anything except the constraint, and the system doesn’t get better.

05 — WHY WE MISS IT

We harden the link we own.

Where teams invest

CHIP · APP

Where attackers go

THE HANDOFFS

Teams polish what they own.

Attackers look for what nobody owns.

06 — THE RESPONSE

LEDGER	Halted sales in Southeast Asia and Hong Kong. Told resellers to pull stock.
TREZOR	Cutting back its reseller network from Jan 1, 2027.

Shorten the chain.
Don’t just harden the chip.

07 — THE LESSON

Clients don’t buy a device. They buy the chain.

01 Map every handoff, factory to first use.

02 Give every handoff an owner.

03 Cut handoffs before hardening links.